

L E S S O N 14

What Does the Holy Spirit Actually Do?

5: The Holy Spirit

Scripture Focus: Acts 2:1-4 · Titus 3:5 · Ephesians 1:13-14 · Romans 8:9

The Spirit's ministry in the Old Testament was temporary and selective — empowering judges, prophets, and kings for specific tasks. But after Pentecost, the Spirit was poured out on all believers, permanently indwelling every Christian. He regenerates, seals, sanctifies, and empowers us for holy living and ministry.

B Y T H E E N D

You Will...

A	Explain the central discipleship issue in your own words.
B	Connect the main truth to Acts 2:1-4 and Titus 3:5 and Ephesians 1:13-14 and Romans 8:9.
C	Name one way this truth should shape your thinking, obedience, prayer, or witness.

V O C A B U L A R Y

Key Terms

THEME	STUDY NOTE
Holy Spirit	The divine Person who indwells, teaches, convicts, empowers, and forms believers into the likeness of Christ.
Salvation	God's gracious rescue of sinners through the finished work of Christ, received by faith rather than earned by works.

THEME	STUDY NOTE
Baptism	The public sign of identification with Christ and His people, pointing to union with Him in death and resurrection.
Scripture	God's written Word, authoritative and sufficient for knowing Him, understanding salvation, and walking faithfully.
Sin	Any failure to love, trust, worship, and obey God as He deserves; sin separates people from God and requires divine rescue.

TEACHING NOTES

I. The Main Question

Christian discipleship begins with learning to see the Holy Spirit Actually Do from Scripture rather than from instinct, habit, or surrounding culture. The goal is not simply to collect religious information, but to have the mind, conscience, and affections trained by God's Word. The Spirit's ministry in the Old Testament was temporary and selective — empowering judges, prophets, and kings for specific tasks. But after Pentecost, the Spirit was poured out on all believers, permanently indwelling every Christian. He regenerates, seals, sanctifies, and empowers us for holy living and ministry.

A growing Christian asks: what does God require me to believe, reject, receive, or practice? Real maturity includes a clearer love for Christ, a humbler view of self, and a more faithful step of obedience.

II. What Scripture Says

Acts 2:1-4 and Titus 3:5 and Ephesians 1:13-14 and Romans 8:9 provide the biblical anchor. These passages keep the discussion tied to God's Word and give the learner a stable foundation for reflection. in this time when you and I accept Jesus Christ as our

savior, the Bible actually tells us that the Holy Spirit permanently indwells you and me and we can't lose him.

Before moving too quickly to application, read the references slowly. Ask what the passage reveals about God, what it says about the human condition, what it commands or promises, and how it points the believer back to Christ. Scripture sets the agenda; Christian reflection follows where God has spoken.

III. The Doctrine Explained

Doctrine matters because discipleship is built on truth. After Jesus's ascension, the Holy Spirit was poured out at the day of Pentecost, Acts chapter 2, marking the birth of the church and the indwelling of all believers. Doctrine is not a detached category for specialists; it names what every Christian is learning to believe, confess, defend, and practice.

Write the doctrine in your own words. Then ask how it fits into the larger story of Scripture: creation, fall, redemption, and Christian growth. A doctrine has been understood more deeply when it begins to reshape worship, repentance, assurance, humility, courage, and love.

SCRIPTURE SPOTLIGHT

Acts 2:1-4

Acts 2:1-4 should be read as more than a proof text. It gives the subject its center of gravity and keeps Christian thinking inside God's revealed Word rather than personal opinion.

Read Acts 2:1-4 first, then read Titus 3:5 and Ephesians 1:13-14 and Romans 8:9. Notice how the passages work together: one may name the doctrine, another may show its consequence, and another may press the believer toward obedience.

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Study the passage:

- 1.** *What does this passage teach about God, Christ, humanity, sin, grace, or obedience?*
 - 2.** *What word or phrase should control how you understand this truth?*
 - 3.** *How would this passage help a newer believer think more clearly?*
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FRAMEWORK

The Spirit's Work in the Believer

THE SPIRIT DOES	THE BELIEVER RESPONDS
Indwells and seals God's people.	Lives with assurance and reverence.
Convicts and teaches through the Word.	Listens, repents, and obeys.
Produces fruit and strengthens witness.	Walks dependently rather than self-reliantly.

PAUSE & REFLECT

Before moving on, write one sentence answering this: where does the Holy Spirit Actually Do most need to become clearer or more obedient in your own life?

IV. Common Confusion

Common confusion usually begins when a biblical truth is reduced to a slogan, separated from its context, or filtered through personal experience. sadly his life was not always serving the Lord and doing and making right choices. New believers especially need help seeing the difference between a biblical category and a half-true assumption.

When confusion appears, do not answer it only with opinion. Return to the text, define your terms, and make careful distinctions. Stability grows as hard questions are brought patiently under Scripture.

V. Why This Matters for Discipleship

Truth becomes fruitful when it forms the disciple. it is something we should be thrilled to experience each and every day of our lives. Biblical teaching should train the believer to worship, repent, trust, forgive, serve, pray, resist sin, and speak the gospel with clarity.

Ask where this truth should create maturity. Does it deepen assurance? Correct pride? Encourage obedience? Make Scripture more central? Strengthen witness? The

question is not merely whether the content is understood, but what kind of disciple the truth is forming.

VI. How This Changes Daily Life

The Holy Spirit Actually Do belongs in ordinary Christian life, not merely in a notebook. when we talk about the Holy Spirit's role in the life of the church, he was the one who empowers the church. Identify one real setting where the truth should matter: a conversation, a temptation, a fear, a decision, a family moment, a church responsibility, or a private habit.

Growing in grace often happens through small, repeated acts of faithfulness. Choose one practice for this week that is concrete enough to obey, simple enough to remember, and biblical enough to strengthen your walk with Christ.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- **the Holy Spirit Actually Do should train the way a believer thinks, worships, and obeys.**
- **Scripture must set the terms before personal experience, church culture, or instinct is allowed to define the issue.**
- **when we look at first the Holy Spirit's work, we want to talk about how he works in scripture.**
- **Christian maturity grows as doctrine moves from information into prayer, repentance, assurance, service, witness, and daily faithfulness.**

REFLECTION

Questions for the Lesson

1. *What should become clearer in your thinking about the holy spirit actually do?*

2. *Where does this truth correct a common misunderstanding or shallow habit?*

3. *What is one concrete step of obedience, prayer, study, or conversation you should take this week?*

PUT INTO PRACTICE

A Discipleship Conversation

Imagine a newer believer asks you about the holy spirit actually do. They are not asking for a lecture; they need a patient, Scripture-shaped answer that helps them trust Christ and take one faithful next step.

Your Task

- 1.** Use Acts 2:1-4 to write a simple, biblical answer in your own words.
 - 2.** Name one practical step you would encourage this person to take this week.
 - 3.** Write one prayer request that fits the truth and the situation.
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